

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 5

♥ K Q T 9 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ Q J 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K 7 6 3

♥ J 4 2

♦ 9 7 4

♣ 8 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1♥		

All Pass
1♥ by North

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 1
[show NS] NORTH has 18 points and a 5-card ♥ suit. This is a good hand to open 1♥.

SOUTH has three ♥s which is adequate support. But SOUTH only has 4 points which is not strong enough to respond. So SOUTH passes.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 8 2
 ♥ K 5 4 3
 ♦ 8 6
 ♣ 9 8 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 9 6 4
 ♥ A 9
 ♦ K 7 4
 ♣ K Q J

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
All Pass 3 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 2

[show NS] SOUTH has 17 points counting 1 extra for the fifth ♠. This is a middle-range hand with five ♠s. So he opens 1 ♠.

NORTH only has 7 points, 6 in high cards and one more for the doubleton ♦. But she does have three ♠s, so she can respond 2 ♠.

Since SOUTH is middle-range, he makes one more try by bidding 3 ♠.

If NORTH had 9 or 10 points she would now bid 4 ♠ - but with 7 she passes.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q 7 5
 ♥ K J 7 4
 ♦ J 9 4 2
 ♣ J 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 9 6 4 2
 ♥ 8 3
 ♦ A 6
 ♣ Q 5 4

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠		
All Pass			
2 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 3

[show NS] With 8 points, NORTH is not strong enough to open the bidding.

SOUTH has 13 points, barely meeting the minimum for a 1-opening. Note that the fifth and sixth ♠ each added 1 point to his count. He opens 1 ♠.

Although NORTH passed originally, she must respond to SOUTH's opening bid. Since she has three ♠s she raises to 2 ♠.

In light of NORTH's weak response SOUTH passes.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ J 6 5

♥ K T 7 5

♦ A 8

♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ A K

♥ Q J 8 6 4 2

♦ K Q 3

♣ 7 5

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 4
[show NS] SOUTH has 17 points and six ♥s. This is a mid-range 1♥ opening bid.

With 9 points, (1 for the doubleton), NORTH raises to 2♥.

SOUTH's hand is worth one more try. He invites with 3♥.

NORTH had a strong 2♥ raise, considering that she might have only had 6 points. So she carries on to 4♥.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ T 9 2
♥ A K 5 4 2
♦ 8 5
♣ A K Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 6 4
♥ Q 7 6 3
♦ A J 4
♣ 9 8 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♥		
All Pass			
3 ♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 5

[show NS] NORTH opens 1 ♥ with 17 points and five ♥s.

SOUTH, with 7 points and four trumps raises to 2 ♥.

NORTH has a mid-range hand, good enough to invite SOUTH to bid the game.

Too bad, but SOUTH is too weak to accept any invitations.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K J 8 7 4

♥ K 7 2

♦ A 9 5

♣ A Q

♠ A 6 3

♥ 9 8 5 3

♦ 8 6 4 3

♣ 9 2

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠		Pass
All Pass			
1 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 6
[show NS] SOUTH has a terrible hand, and naturally passes.

NORTH, however, has a nice 18 points and opens 1 ♠.

SOUTH still has a terrible hand, and passes again. You need at least 6 points to respond to an opening one bid.

Board 7
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q J 5 4

♥ A 7

♦ K Q 5

♣ J 8 6

♠ T 9 6 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ A 7

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass 4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 7

[show NS] NORTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1 ♠.

SOUTH has good ♠ support and 10 points, counting 1 for the doubleton ♣. It is easily worth a raise to 2 ♠

NORTH cannot bid game yet, after all, SOUTH could have as few as 6 points. But she can continue with a 3 ♠ bid in hopes that SOUTH actually has 9 or 10 points.

SOUTH comes through with 4 ♠.

Board 8
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 8 7 2

♥ Q 9 6 4

♦ K 6 2

♣ A Q 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K J 6

♥ K J 8 5 2

♦ A 7 4

♣ 8 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	3 ♥		
All Pass			
3 ♥ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 8
[show NS] SOUTH has a bare minimum 13 point hand, and he should open 1 ♥.

NORTH has 11 points and good ♥ support so she jumps to 3 ♥.

SOUTH knows he has been invited to bid higher, but with nothing above minimum he must pass.

Board 9
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ Q J

♥ J 8 5 4

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ Q J 7

♠ 8 6 3

♥ A K Q 7 2

♦ K 6

♣ T 9 5

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥		
All Pass			
3♥ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 9
[show NS] NORTH has 11 points and she should pass.

SOUTH has a minimum 1♥ opening, 13 points and five trumps.

NORTH, with 4-card trump support, jumps to 3♥.
(This is called a Limit Raise.)

A Limit Raise is an invitational bid, but SOUTH can add and he knows the total points will be either 24 or 25. So he passes 3♥.

None Vul

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 6 2

♥ K Q 7 5

♦ 83

♣ T 7 4



 —
 —
 —
 —

♠ K Q T 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♠

All Pass
2♠ by South

1 ♠

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 10

[show NS] SOUTH has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

NORTH has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to $2\spadesuit$.

SOUTH passes, knowing he is not missing a game contract. NORTH can have a maximum of 10 points, which would only reach 24 points when added to his 14.

Board 11

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -	♠ A Q 7 5 3	♠ -
♥ -	♥ K Q	♥ -
♦ -	♦ A 8 7 6	♦ -
♣ -	♣ 9 4	♣ -
	N W E S	
	♠ K 6 4 2	
	♥ J 8 5	
	♦ K 3 2	
	♣ A 6 2	

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 11

[show NS] With a 5-card ♠ suit and 16 points

NORTH should open 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 11 points and four ♠s. So even though he has a balanced hand, he jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

NORTH adds: her 16 plus SOUTH's 11/12 equals a game, 4 ♠.

Board 12
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K Q 7

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ Q 9 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ J T 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass 4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 12

[show NS] SOUTH has the type of 5-card Major hand that many players would open 1NT. He has 17 points with most of them OUTSIDE the Major suit. But, many others would disagree so for this Deal SOUTH will open 1 ♠.

NORTH has 11 points and excellent (is that strong enough?) ♠ support. So she naturally makes a Limit Raise of 3 ♠.

SOUTH adds the points and ignores the fact that his ♠ suit is Jack high. He bids 4 ♠.

Board 13

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 5
♥ Q J T 8 3
♦ K Q J
♣ 9 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6 4
♥ K 9 5 2
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ A K

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass
4 ♥ by North

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 13

[show NS] NORTH has a minimum 1 ♥ opening bid
- 13 points and five trumps.

SOUTH also has opening hand strength, 14 points
for him. He also has four of NORTH's ♥s. He
applies the "He who knows, goes" principle and bids
4 ♥.

IMPORTANT NOTE: Most experienced bridge pairs
would not bid the hand quite this way, although they
would arrive at the same contract. See some of the
other BakerBridge lessons for more details.

Board 14
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q 9 2

♥ Q J

♦ Q 7 6 4

♣ J 8 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A J T 8 7 4

♥ A K 5

♦ A K 3

♣ 9

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 14
[show NS] SOUTH has a powerful hand (21 points) with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1 ♠.

NORTH has an 11-point Limit Raise with four trumps. She jumps to 3 ♠.

SOUTH now knows that the partnership holds at least 32 points, perhaps 33. Since he can see that the opponents have no way to win the first two tricks he decides to bid the slam, 6 ♠

Board 15
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 7 6 5 2

♥ 7 6

♦ A 8 3

♣ A J 4

♠ J T 9 4 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ 9

♣ K 8 6 3

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	4 ♠

All Pass
4 ♠ by North

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 15
[show NS] NORTH has 14 points and opens 1 ♠, her 5-card Major.

SOUTH could bid 3 ♠, a Limit Raise with his 11 points. But it is often a good idea, when you have five of the Major suit that partner opened with, to just go ahead and bid the game. So South should bid 4 ♠ here.

See the NOTE in Deal 13. When you use weaker 5-card support hands for your jump to game, you need to find another way to describe your opening-hand-strength type hands.

Board 16

South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 9 4

♥ A K 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ K 9 6 2

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A 8 7

♥ T 9 8 6 3

♦ A 6 2

♣ A 8

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 16

[show NS] SOUTH has 13 points so he must open. He has five ♥s so he should open 1♥.

NORTH, with 14 points and four ♥s knows there are enough points for a game contract and at least nine ♥s between the partners. She who KNOWS, GOES, so NORTH bids 4♥.

This is similar to Deal 13.

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 9
 ♥ A K J 6 5
 ♦ A T 5
 ♣ A 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 8 2
 ♥ Q 8 4 3
 ♦ K 7 4
 ♣ K Q 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 17

[show NS] NORTH has 20 points, a pretty strong hand to open 1 ♥.

SOUTH has 12 points, and makes a Limit Raise, a jump to 3 ♥.

NORTH is very, very close to bidding a slam. But she knows SOUTH has 12 points at most, so she should take the safe position and just bid 4 ♥.

Board 18
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A J 6 5 3

♥ J T 9

♦ A Q 5 4

♣ 6

♠ Q 9 8 7 4 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 8 6

♣ 9 5

N

W E

S

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	Pass
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 18
[show NS] SOUTH passes to start with since he only has 9 points.

NORTH naturally opens 1 ♠ with her 13 point, 5-card ♠ suit hand.

SOUTH might now make a Limit Raise since his hand is now worth 11 points because of the two doubletons. However, with six trumps he should jump all the way to 4 ♠.

Board 19
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A Q 9 7 5 3

♥ Q 7

♦ A K 3

♣ K 2

♠ J T 8 2

♥ K 5 2

♦ 8 6

♣ Q 7 6 3

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 19

[show NS] NORTH has 20 points, counting two extra for the fifth and sixth ♠s. Naturally she opens 1 ♠.

SOUTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. He has four of partner's ♠s so he responds 2 ♠.

NORTH KNOWS that $6 + 20 = 26$, so she GOES to 4 ♠.

Board 20

South Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ J 8

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 9 7 5 3

♣ T 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 7 4

♥ A J 8 7 2

♦ K Q J

♣ A 3

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 20

[show NS] SOUTH has 20 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♥ rather than 2NT.

NORTH barely has enough points for a response, but she does have four ♥s. So she responds 2♥.

SOUTH adds NORTH's 6 to his 20 and bids the game, 4♥.

Board 21

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A

♥ K Q 9 8 7 4 2

♦ K Q

♣ K 4 2

♠ J 8 6 3

♥ 6 3

♦ J 8 4 3

♣ 8 7 5

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
	1♥		

All Pass
1♥ by North

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 21

[show NS] NORTH has 20 points because she gets to add one point each for her fifth, sixth and seventh ♥s. So she opens 1♥.

SOUTH, with just 2 points, would have passed almost anything NORTH bid. Certainly he passes the 1♥ bid.

Board 22
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ J 8 4 2
 ♥ 9 7 6
 ♦ Q J
 ♣ A K 7 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q T 6 5
 ♥ K Q 2
 ♦ K 8 7
 ♣ 8 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass 4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 22

[show NS] SOUTH has 14 points so he opens one of his 5-card Major suit, 1 ♠.

NORTH has some good ♣s, but with four of partner's Major she doesn't bother bidding anything else. Since she has 11 points she jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

SOUTH is very close to passing. He now gets to add a point for his doubleton ♣ which takes him up to 15 points. So he has enough to bid 4 ♠.

Board 23

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K J 8 7 2
♥ A 9 8
♦ K Q J
♣ 6 5



♠ T 9 5 3
♥ K J 2
♦ A 5
♣ K 7 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass 4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 23
[show NS] NORTH has a normal opening bid of 1 ♠.

SOUTH has a Limit Raise in ♠s, 11 points and 4 ♠s. He responds 3 ♠

NORTH figures that 15 points is enough for game with partner showing 11/12. She bids 4 ♠.

Board 24

South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 6

♥ A Q 8 7 6 4 2

♦ A 3

♣ 4 2

♠ 5 4 3

♥ K 5 3

♦ T 6 5

♣ Q J 8 5

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
			Pass
Pass	1♥	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥		
All Pass			
3♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicMajor 24
[show NS] SOUTH has 6 points and wouldn't dream of opening.

NORTH has 17 points, counting three extra length points, so she opens 1♥.

SOUTH does have enough to raise to 2♥.

NORTH makes one more try, inviting with a 3♥ bid but SOUTH just passes.